

news feed

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hypothesis

OQO

■ What is it?
OQO from Seattle brings forth the 'ultra personal' computer—a PDA that is a whole computer by itself. Priced at \$1,000, it'll be out in the second half of 2002.

■ So what?

It runs on Windows XP and is powered by a 5800 Crusoe processor from Transmeta. With a 10 GB hard drive, 256 MB memory, FireWire



and USB connection ports, it packs the punch of a desktop PC in a palm-sized package. It even has wireless networking with WiFi or Bluetooth.

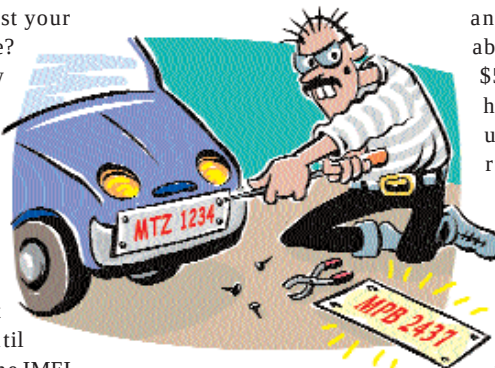
snapshot

Global revenues from Multimedia Messaging Services (MMS) will be **\$31 billion** in person-to-person applications and **\$39 billion** in machine-to-person applications by 2007

Source: FT Investor

Hacking your mobile phone

Have you ever lost your mobile phone? If you know your mobile's unique IMEI (International Mobile Equipment Identity) number, you can effectively block your phone from being used on GSM networks. At least that used to be the case until recently. You can find the IMEI number by typing ***#06#** on your phone. Trust evildoers to find a way around that as well. There is a whole load of soft-



ware available on the Net, which makes changing the mobile's IMEI as easy as pie. 'Chipping' kits with cables

and software are now available on the Net for around \$50 (approx Rs 2,500). All a hacker has to do is to hook up the phone to a PC and run the software. IMEI is very much like a credit card number wherein only certain combinations of numbers work. The software tries out various combinations till it comes up with one that works. It takes just a few seconds to change the IMEI number. This only proves that no technology is 'crack'-proof.

BBC's ad-free, porn-free search engine

Gone are the days when you could simply search for a term in a search engine and come up

an end to all this. This all-new search engine does not use any advertising and uses screening to remove pornography, racist material and offensive sites. The search engine makes use of a mix of Google's and BBC's in-house technology.

However, there's a catch in BBC's search engine. Although it finds sites from around the world, preferential ranking is given to British sites. This happened as a result of BBC's survey of Net users which revealed that they are tired of search results showing predominantly US sites. Only time will tell how good the quality of the results are.

Check it out for yourself at www.bbc.co.uk.



with relevant results. Most search engines these days allow advertisers to pay in order to obtain a higher ranking in search results.

BBC's recently launched BBCi search engine tries to put

Future home

Microsoft is investing heavily in the eHome concept wherein every device in the home will be interconnected. To promote this, Microsoft has tied up with Israel-based Itran Communications and will release a hardware and software developer kit by the year-end.

Microsoft is banking on SCP (Simple Control Protocol) for eHome. SCP will help devices find and control each other. This protocol doesn't need a PC, but Longhorn, the next version of Windows XP, will have support for SCP. SCP is an extension of Microsoft's UPnP (Universal Plug and Play), supported by Windows Me and XP. But unlike UPnP, SCP does not depend upon TCP/IP.